# Ideation Phase

# Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

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| **Date** | 21 September 2026 |
| **Team ID** | Individual Project |
| **Project Name** | ServiceNow-Based Employee Laptop Request Application |
| **Maximum Marks** | 4 Marks |
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| **College** | Lendi Institute of Engineering and Technology |

## Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages creative thinking and problem solving. Volume is prioritized over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and every idea is later grouped and prioritized.

## Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

- **Participant:** Pasapu Vineela (individual project). Role: developer and ServiceNow administrator.
- **Goal:** Replace manual emails and verbal requests with a standardized digital workflow for employee laptop requests.
- **Tools and skills:** ServiceNow Personal Developer Instance (PDI), Service Catalog and Record Producer, Business Rules, Workflow Automation, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Update Sets and custom application scope.
- **Problem statement (How might we...?):** How might we give employees one simple platform to request laptops (Basic or Advance), prevent duplicate requests within a year, and give IT and management clear status tracking and accountability?
- **Key rules followed:** stay on topic, defer judgment, encourage wild ideas, go for volume, listen to others, be visual.

## Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

**Ideas listed:**

1. Service Portal Record Producer as the front-end entry point where employees submit laptop requests.
2. Custom table "Laptop Request Form" with Number (auto number), Requester, Employee Email, Request Date, Short Description, Manager, Type of Request, Status and Reason.
3. Choice field for Type of Request: Basic (personal or general office use) or Advance (software development or technical work).
4. Choice field for Reason: Software Development, Personal Use or Other, captured for justification.
5. Status choices: Pending Approval, Approved, Rejected, so every request has visible tracking.
6. Business rule to restrict one laptop request per employee per year.
7. Clear error message and handling for duplicate requests.
8. Default values and field validations (for example default status Pending Approval, request date auto-filled).
9. Reference fields to the User table so requester and manager details are auto-populated.
10. Role-based access control so employees see only their own requests and IT sees all.
11. Manager approval workflow with automatic assignment of the approval task.
12. Email notifications for submission, approval and rejection to employee, manager and IT.

13. Fulfilment task for IT after approval, to give a timely and transparent asset allocation.
14. Reports and dashboard of requests by status, type and reason for management.
15. Custom application scope and Update Set so all configuration is organized and portable.
16. End-to-end testing of request creation, choice values and duplicate handling before automation.

**Grouped ideas (themes):**

| Group (theme) | Ideas | Linked execution milestone |
|---|---|---|
| Project setup and structure | 15 | Milestone 1 (Update Set) and Milestone 2 (Custom Application) |
| Request submission and data model | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 9 | Milestone 3 (Table Design and Data Model) |
| Validation and control | 6, 7, 8, 10 | Milestone 4 (Request Logic and Business Rules) |
| Testing and readiness | 16 | Milestone 5 (Validation, Testing and Readiness) |
| Approval, notification and reporting | 11, 12, 13, 14 | Future enhancements (approval workflow, notifications, reporting) |

## Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Each idea is rated on Importance (positive impact if done without difficulty or cost) and Feasibility (cost, time, effort, complexity).

| Idea | Importance | Feasibility | Priority |
|---|---|---|---|
| Custom table and Record Producer form (1, 2) | High | High | Do first |
| Type of Request and Reason choice fields (3, 4) | High | High | Do first |
| One request per employee per year rule and duplicate error (6, 7) | High | High | Do first |
| Default values, validations, reference fields (8, 9) | High | High | Do first |
| Status tracking (5) | High | High | Do first |
| Update Set and custom application scope (15) | Medium | High | Do first (setup) |
| Role-based access control (10) | High | Medium | Do next |
| Testing before automation (16) | High | High | Do next |
| Manager approval workflow (11) | High | Medium | Next phase |
| Email notifications (12) | Medium | High | Next phase |
| IT fulfilment task (13) | Medium | Medium | Later |
| Reports and dashboard (14) | Medium | Medium | Later |

**Selected for development (this phase):** the Laptop Request Form table, Record Producer, Basic/Advance and Reason choices, status tracking, validations and the one-request-per-year rule, built inside a custom application with an Update Set. Approval workflows, notifications and reporting are prepared as the next enhancements.

Reference: https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization